
PAPERBOY

MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 7, 2026

The AfD took 44.1 per cent in Saxony-Anhalt, the largest result the German far right has ever recorded in a state election, and finished three seats short of being able to govern alone.

AI

No model, product or safety release landed in the window, and nothing new from the labs since 1 September. The one live AI story this morning is a legal one.

Anthropic's \$1.5bn author settlement runs into a fight over who gets paid

WHAT HAPPENED

Settlement notices in *Bartz v. Anthropic* have started reaching authors, and [TechCrunch reported on 6 September](#) that the claims process is generating disputes between authors and their own publishers and agents. The settlement covers roughly 500,000 titles at about \$3,000 per pirated work; in-print books split 50-50 between author and publisher, while self-published works and those whose rights reverted before 10 August 2022 pay the author in full. Three patterns are being reported: publishers claiming books whose rights reverted years ago, publishers demanding the whole award where they are entitled to half, and literary agents claiming a percentage of a payment they hold no rights to. Victoria Strauss of *Writer Beware* said the “unusually large number of reports” suggests “something much more widespread and systemic.” This is effectively single-outlet: a corroborating Publishers Lunch item would not load.

WHAT IT MEANS

The \$1.5bn figure was the headline, and it was treated across the industry as the template for every AI copyright case behind it. What the settlement did not do is resolve who at the receiving end owns the claim, and that is a contract question about decades of publishing agreements rather than anything to do with Anthropic. Every subsequent settlement inherits the same problem, and the administration cost is now a visible part of the price.

WATCH NEXT

First disbursements are not expected before late autumn. Whether the claims administrator publishes a dispute-resolution procedure is the thing to look for.

Asian chip names rip on a Friday divergence Wall Street did not get to confirm

WHAT HAPPENED

Korea and Japan opened the week hard. The Kospi closed [up 4.61 per cent at 6,995.39](#) and the Nikkei 225 [up 2.12 per cent at 66,399.84](#), with the chip complex leading: [Samsung Electronics +4.11 per cent at 266,000 won](#), [SK Hynix +5.46 per cent at 1,737,000 won](#) and [Kioxia +7.93 per cent at ¥58,780](#), alongside Advantest [+5.70 per cent](#) and Tokyo Electron [+4.74 per cent](#). The trigger was the 4 September US session, where the Philadelphia Semiconductor Index rose more than 3 per cent while all three major US indices fell. Hong Kong went the other way, the Hang Seng closing down 226 points at 25,428. Reported Nikkei closes vary between +2.02 and +2.12 per cent across outlets; that is snapshot timing, not a dispute.

WHAT IT MEANS

This is the memory-led rally from last week extending, and the shape of it matters: the tape is separating semiconductors from everything else rather than lifting the whole market. It is also unconfirmed by the market that started it, because US exchanges were shut on Monday for Labor Day. A one-way Asian session on a US holiday is a weak signal until New York votes on Tuesday.

WATCH NEXT

Apple on 9 September is the first consumer pass-through test of memory pricing; TSMC's August revenue lands around 10 September and Micron reports on 30 September. No new DRAM contract data in the window — TrendForce's most recent release is still 3 July — and no export-control action.

German industrial output falls 1.1 per cent, and the cars are the reason

WHAT HAPPENED

Destatis [reported on 7 September](#) that production fell 1.1 per cent in July from June, seasonally and calendar adjusted, and 1.6 per cent year on year. June was revised down from a preliminary +0.2 per cent to flat. Motor vehicles and parts fell 9.2 per cent on the month, which Destatis attributes to a multi-week production shutdown; capital goods fell 3.4 per cent, consumer goods 2.2 per cent and energy-intensive branches 1.7 per cent, while energy production rose 4.7 per cent and construction 0.9 per cent. Over the three months to July, output was still 0.4 per cent above the previous three. Press reports put the consensus at a small rise; that is not a Destatis number, and the widely repeated “biggest drop in nearly a year” is an outlet's characterisation rather than anything in the release.

WHAT IT MEANS

Volkswagen's restructuring plan was approved on 3 September and the July auto number predates it, so this is the old problem showing up in the data rather than the new plan taking effect. For the ECB, which meets on Wednesday, it is the awkward half of the picture: headline inflation at 3.3 per cent argues one way, a shrinking industrial base the other.

WATCH NEXT

The ECB on 10 September, and whether Lagarde is asked to reconcile 3.3 per cent inflation with a contracting German factory sector.

Oil holds its war premium in a session the US sat out

WHAT HAPPENED

Brent traded around **\$96.74, up 0.48 per cent**, and WTI around **\$91.56, up 0.09 per cent**, on Monday. These are intraday electronic quotes, not settlements: US markets were closed for Labor Day. The move is a continuation of last week's, which [Reuters put at 9.7 per cent for WTI](#), an \$8.08 gain from the prior Friday's \$83.40 and the strongest weekly advance since mid-July. Brent's weekly gain is genuinely contested, reported as 7.6 per cent on a comparable-contract basis and as 9.3 per cent elsewhere; we are not settling it. European equities were flat to slightly lower, the Stoxx 600 off 0.1 per cent. Gold slipped 0.46 per cent to \$4,412.30, far below its January record.

WHAT IT MEANS

The premium is being paid for the US-Iran tanker exchange and the naval blockade of Iran's southern ports, not for any change in physical supply that has actually been measured. That makes it reversible in a single headline, and it is also the mechanism by which a Gulf shooting war reaches American petrol stations eight weeks before the midterms.

WATCH NEXT

Tuesday's US reopening is the real test of Monday's Asian move. *Correction: this brief previously reported Brent settling at \$92.68 on 4 September, taken from a Reuters line. That figure is inconsistent with the confirmed Thursday settle and with WTI at \$91.48; the evidence points to roughly \$96.28, and we should not have printed the lower number.*

Novartis loses a \$3bn-a-year drug at the conference podium

WHAT HAPPENED

Novartis fell around 3.3 per cent on Monday after the full results for pelacarsen, licensed from Ionis, were presented at the European Society of Cardiology meeting. The drug lowers lipoprotein(a), a genetically determined cardiovascular risk factor with no approved treatment, but [did not cut heart attacks or strokes](#) in the late-stage trial. Analysts had modelled \$3bn to \$6bn in annual peak sales. The topline miss was disclosed on 4 September; what moved the stock on Monday was the full data. Attention now shifts to del-desiran, the muscular dystrophy asset Novartis bought for \$12bn last year.

WHAT IT MEANS

Lp(a) has been the most confidently modelled unmet need in cardiology for a decade, and this was the first read on whether lowering it actually helps. A clean miss on outcomes does not just cost Novartis a product, it marks down the whole category and takes competitive pressure off the Amgen and Lilly programmes behind it.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Amgen and Lilly restate their own Lp(a) timelines, and how hard Novartis is pushed on pipeline depth at its next investor update.

STARTUPS

Nothing. No funding round, no shutdown, no down round and no S-1 that could be verified in the window. Worth noting that EDGAR does not accept weekend filings and reopens at 6am Eastern on Monday, right at the edge of this window, so a Monday morning filing would not yet be visible — this is “none found” rather than “none occurred.”

The Postal Service quietly withdrew its own Supreme Court application

WHAT HAPPENED

Application 26A297, *United States Postal Service et al. v. California et al.*, was docketed on 3 September and submitted to Justice Jackson, who ordered a response by 10am Eastern on 8 September. Amicus briefs came in from the Society for the Rule of Law Institute on 4 September and from a private individual on 5 September. Then, on 6 September, the [docket recorded a letter withdrawing the application, and the application withdrawn](#). Tuesday's deadline is moot. No reason is given on the docket beyond the letter itself, and we found no news coverage of the withdrawal anywhere — this comes from the Court's own docket, which is authoritative but is also the only source.

WHAT IT MEANS

Governments do not usually walk away from emergency applications they have just filed, and they especially do not do it the day before the other side's brief is due. The most likely explanation is that something changed in the posture below and made the stay unnecessary; a letter about the preliminary injunction was filed by the applicants on 4 September. That is inference, not reporting, and we are flagging it as such.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the underlying district-court order is modified or the case returns on a different application.

Missouri's mail-voting stay hits its deadline at noon

WHAT HAPPENED

Application 26A304, *Hoskins v. Von Glahn*, is the Missouri Secretary of State's request to stay a ruling on mail voting. It was filed on 4 September and submitted to Justice Kavanaugh, who [requested a response by noon Eastern on Monday 7 September](#). The Republican National Committee, the National Republican Congressional Committee and the Missouri Republican State Committee filed jointly in support the same day. As of this morning nothing further has been docketed: no response, no order. The deadline falls after this brief closes.

WHAT IT MEANS

The timing is the point. Missouri's ballot deadline is 8 September, so a stay that arrives late is a stay that does nothing, and Kavanaugh's noon deadline is calibrated to that rather than to the merits. This is the third mail-voting emergency application in a fortnight, which is itself the story ahead of November.

WATCH NEXT

The docket after noon Eastern today, and the 8 September ballot deadline. Separately: nothing on the White House presidential-actions page dated 6 or 7 September, the most recent items being two 4 September executive orders on ranchers and livestock markets. Congress returns on 11 September.

AfD takes 44.1 per cent in Saxony-Anhalt and lands three seats short

WHAT HAPPENED

With all 2,661 districts counted, the preliminary final result gives the AfD 44.1 per cent and 39 of the Landtag's 83 seats. An absolute majority is 42. The CDU fell to 17.1 per cent and 15 seats, down 25; the SPD took 9.3 per cent, the Greens 8.9, the Left 8.5 and the BSW 5.3, at eight, eight, eight and five seats; the FDP missed the threshold on 2.6 per cent. Turnout was 76.9 per cent against 60.3 in 2021, when the AfD polled 20.8 per cent. Alice Weidel said the party was seeing “explosive growth here” and would see “explosive growth across all of East Germany — and at the federal level, too”; lead candidate Ulrich Siegmund said [“We have made history in this country.”](#) A note on framing: this is the AfD's largest state result, not its first state-election win, which was Thuringia in 2024.

WHAT IT MEANS

Doubling a vote share while the CDU halves its own is the arithmetic that makes the firewall expensive rather than merely awkward. Every other party has ruled out governing with the AfD, so a coalition now requires assembling 42 seats from five parties that agree on very little beyond exclusion. If that fails, the alternative is a minority government or a re-run, and either outcome is an argument the AfD gets to make for free.

WATCH NEXT

Coalition talks, and official certification of the count. Federally, whether the CDU leadership's position on the firewall survives the post-mortem.

Witkoff and Kushner get to Kyiv, and say almost nothing about what was agreed

WHAT HAPPENED

The two envoys met Zelensky in Kyiv on 6 September, a day after seeing Putin in Moscow and their first visit to the Ukrainian capital since the February 2022 invasion. The Ukrainian presidency's [own readouts, timestamped 6 September 22:39 and 7 September 00:24](#), describe three rounds of talks, including a separate round with the French, British and German national security advisers Emmanuel Bonne, Jonathan Powell and Günter Sautter. Zelensky said that “negotiations to end Russia's war against our country are important in any format in which such diplomatic steps are possible.” Witkoff said the discussion was “very meaningful, substantive, important, and we are very encouraged and we look forward to continuing this as long as it takes.” Kushner, in reported speech rather than a direct quote, framed the aim as a long-term durable peace rather than only an end to fighting. No terms were published by anyone.

WHAT IT MEANS

The readout is warm and empty, which is not nothing after three years without an American delegation in Kyiv, but the asymmetry is worth watching: the Moscow leg produced detailed discussion of economic projects while the Kyiv leg produced adjectives. Meanwhile the war did not pause. Over the preceding 24 hours eight people were killed and 69 injured, Russia launched 108 drones, Ukraine says it downed 82 of them plus six missiles, and Ukraine struck the Ryazan refinery some 480km inside Russia.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the capitals-only halt on aerial strikes is extended, dropped or simply lapses — as of this morning there is no confirmed extension and no confirmed collapse, and earlier reporting that it broke on the first night is unresolved against Kyiv reporting no strikes on the city. Then: whether “next steps” becomes a document.

SOURCES

[Destatis — Production in July 2026: -1.1% on the previous month](#)

[Supreme Court docket 26A297 — USPS v. California \(application withdrawn\)](#)

[Supreme Court docket 26A304 — Hoskins v. Von Glahn](#)

[President of Ukraine — official readouts, 6-7 September](#)

[Al Jazeera — US envoys hold substantive talks with Zelenskyy in first visit to Kyiv](#)

[NPR — Far-right AfD wins Saxony-Anhalt state election](#)

[Landeswahlleiterin Sachsen-Anhalt — preliminary final result](#)

[Kyiv Independent — Russian attacks kill 8, injure 69 over past day](#)

[Reuters via EnergyNow — Oil posts biggest weekly gain since July](#)

[Trading Economics — Brent crude](#)

TradingKey — Japan and South Korea chip names, 7 September

Yahoo Finance — Novartis shares down after failed pelacarsen study

TechCrunch — AI feed (Anthropic settlement claims)